Sulṭān Baysonqor Mīrzā Is Killed

Khusrau Shah had already set his plans to lead an army against Balkh. In the same year, he had invited Sulṭān Baysonqor Mīrzā to go with him and they both rode out from Kunduz to Balkh.

But Khusrau Shah showed his true colours as they reached Aubaj ferry. On 17 August of AD 1499, he along with his confidants showered arrows on Baysonqor Mīrzā and his begs killing him immediately.

One can say that Shah's aspiration to gain sovereignty was the reason for his actions. Babur has said that Khusrau indeed was aware that being a man of no merit, lineage, judgment, magnanimity, justice and no legal mindedness could have ever gained so without laying hands on Baysonqor Mīrzā. One scion of sovereignty was martyred in the name of greed.

Babur mentions that Baysonqor Mīrzā was well-accomplished, sweet-natured, and well-adorned by birth and lineage.

He was born to Pasha Begum and Sulṭān Mahmud Mīrzā as the latter's second son in AD 1477 in the district of Hisar. Sulṭān Masud Mīrzā was his first son born to Khānzada Begum. Other sons of Sulṭān Mahumd, younger than Baysonqor Mīrzā were Sulṭān Ali Mīrzā (son of Zuhra Begi Agha), Husayn Mīrzā (died at the age of thirteen, son of the second Khānzada Begum) and Sulṭān Wais Mīrzā known as Mīrzā Khān (son of Sulṭān Nigar Khānum).

Baysonqor Mīrzā has been elaborately described in the *Baburnama*. According to Babur, Baysonqor Mīrzā was of average height and had the features of a Turkman with large eyes buttoned to his fleshy face. Babur described him as an elegant young person, one of the most accomplished scions of the sovereignty and possessed of a humane and pleasant nature. He was tutored by a Shi'a Sayyid Mahmud, and hence he was often considered a heretic.

Babur mentions in the *Baburnama*,[*] that as the sayings in Samarkand went in those days, he reverted from that evil belief to the pure Faith recently. These hints of Babur's extreme contempt against the Shi'a school of Islam.